

Science understanding



Verbal/linguistic

- 1 Complete the following table that shows some physical factors in an ecosystem. **Explain** at least one way each factor can affect living organisms.

Physical factor (abiotic factor)	One way in which this factor can affect living organisms
Water	All cells need water for their chemistry to work.
Temperature	
Fire	
Light	
Soil minerals	
Gas level	

Table 9.6.1 Effects of abiotic factors on living organisms

- 2 Complete the following table. **Describe** the meaning and give an example of each of the biotic factors listed.

Biotic factor	Meaning/definition	Example
Competition		Baby birds in the nest trying to get food from the parent
Predation	One organism (predator) killing and eating another (prey)	
Mutualism		The flagellates in termite guts
Commensalism	Organisms living together where one benefits and the other is unharmed	
Parasitism		Tapeworm and human
Decomposers		Fungus decaying a dead tree

Table 9.6.2 Meanings of biotic factors